

INDIA THREAT INTELLIGENCE REPORT

CYBER RISK AND CASE STUDIES (2025–2026)

Document Abstract: This restricted report compiles verified telemetry, regional statistics, and chronicled cybersecurity incidents targeting Indian enterprises, government infrastructures, and critical networks between January 2025 and May 2026. The findings trace an accelerating threat landscape characterized by the rapid proliferation of artificial intelligence-powered attack mechanisms, coordinated geopolitical hybrid campaigns, and expanding third-party supply chain exploits.

Document Identification & Sourcing

This threat intelligence report is constructed utilizing consolidated telemetry from Seqrite Labs (India's largest dedicated malware analysis center tracking over 8 million endpoint devices), verified incident response logs, dark web forum postings evaluated by CYFIRMA research teams, and official Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) bulletins.

1. Enterprise Attack Telemetry and Regional Targeting

During the period spanning October 2025 through May 2026, enterprise networks across India absorbed an intense wave of digital threats. Telemetry data shows that malware detections exceeded 15.63 crore (156.3 million) across monitored environments, with March 2026 recording the highest monthly detection volume. When evaluated across the full year of 2025, detections exceeded 26.55 crore (265.52 million) across 8 million+ endpoints, translating into a staggering national average of 505 threat detections every minute.

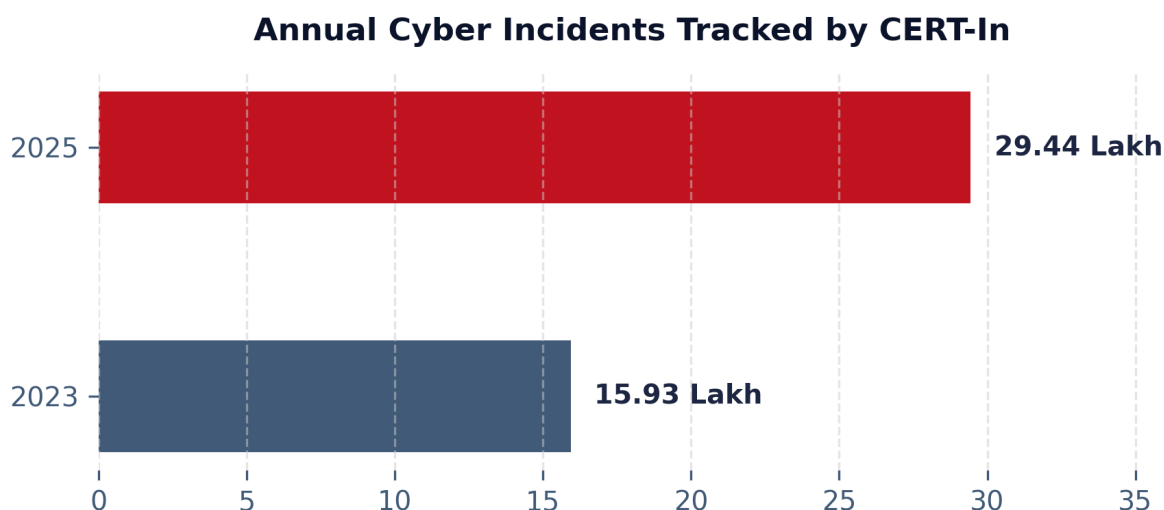


Figure 1.1: Aggregated growth in cyber incidents tracked by CERT-In (2023 vs 2025).

Trojans and File Infectors make up the absolute majority of digital threats, accounting for 70% of all recorded detections. Specifically, Seqrite Labs identified the 'Troublesome Trio' of active payloads as Trojans (88.44 million), File Infectors (71.09 million), and Worms (13.81 million). Detections are predominantly concentrated in on-premise environments, which absorb 91% of malware detections, while cloud-native environments have rapidly scaled as the primary vector of severe enterprise breaches. Spatially, the hardest-hit industrial regions are Maharashtra, Gujarat, and the National Capital Territory of Delhi, with the metropolis of Mumbai, Kolkata, and New Delhi emerging as the primary municipal targets. The Education, Healthcare, and Manufacturing sectors remain the most frequently compromised, collectively absorbing 47% of total threat volumes.

2. Coordinated Geopolitical and Critical Infrastructure Campaigns

Critical information infrastructure has become the front line for state-sponsored geopolitical friction and hacktivist coordination. Between May 7 and May 10, 2025, India was subjected to a highly coordinated wave of cyber activity dubbed **Operation Sindoor**. Attributed broadly to Pakistan-aligned hacktivist and state-linked groups, the operation launched simultaneous attacks. The official public-facing website of the President of India was subjected to a distributed denial-of-service (DDoS) flood that caused disruptions for approximately 19 hours. Simultaneously, the national power grid was subjected to over 200,000 active probing and scanning attempts targeting operational technology gateways, while coordinated defacements and DDoS strikes hit the National Informatics Centre (NIC) data centers, central ministries, and defense research networks.

Additional infrastructure disruptions in 2025 confirmed this trend. On May 2, 2025, the Power Grid Corporation of India's public web portal suffered a 31-minute DDoS outage, disrupting customer-facing bill payments. On April 25-26, 2025, BSNL (the state-owned telecom provider) was hit by consecutive DDoS attacks exceeding 30 minutes each, which resulted in the national billing portal remaining completely inaccessible for multiple days, halting nationwide customer billing and support workflows.

3. Ransomware Campaigns and High-Impact Data Extortion

Ransomware activity in India continues to expand, driven by a fragmented and highly specialized ecosystem of Ransomware-as-a-Service (RaaS) operations. In early 2026, the newly emerged Sinobi ransomware group initiated a major campaign targeting IT service providers and managed solutions companies. Compromising vulnerable VPN access gateways, Sinobi gained unauthorized access to Hyper-V virtualization servers, hosted virtual machines, and customer-sensitive backup environments. This intrusion enabled the extraction of over 150 GB of sensitive customer contracts, proprietary source files, and financial records from multiple downstream environments, demonstrating a classic supply chain multiplication attack.

This followed the January 2025 ransomware attack on Tata Technologies, where the Hunters International ransomware group claimed the exfiltration of 1.4 TB of corporate data. On the night of June 10-11, 2025, two major medical institutions in Delhi—Sant Parmanand Hospital (Civil Lines) and NKS Super Speciality Hospital (Gulabi Bagh)—suffered severe server hacks. The intrusion completely disrupted digital OPD and IPD workflows, forcing medical staff to revert to manual paper-based patient operations.

Extortion campaigns have also taken on aggressive physical dimensions. In May 2025, following a massive customer data breach, Star Health Insurance was subjected to escalatory extortion from an actor using the pseudonym 'xenZen'. The threat actor, who had previously leaked medical records via interactive chat scripts and demanded \$68,000, sent direct physical threats and bullet cartridges to the residences of the company's chief executive and financial officers. The same 'xenZen' pseudonym was linked to the February 2025 breach of Niva Bupa Health Insurance, where customer data was published on the dedicated dark web site 'NivaBupaLeaks.com' following a refusal to meet extortion demands.

4. Cloud Vulnerabilities and Third-Party Supply Chains

Enterprise cloud infrastructure has become the primary attack surface for modern intrusions, with DSCI telemetry indicating that 62% of all malware and access detections occur in cloud environments. These breaches are heavily driven by misconfigured APIs, publicly exposed storage buckets, and overly permissive IAM settings. On February 28, 2025, Angel One, a leading stockbroking platform, disclosed unauthorized access to its AWS-hosted resources, triggered by a dark web intelligence alert revealing exposed access credentials. In another high-profile supply chain compromise, the Bashe ransomware group compromised a third-party vendor portal associated with ICICI Bank in 2025, leveraging the vendor's trusted access point to harvest corporate credentials. Furthermore, small and mid-sized partners remain highly targeted; in February 2026, the CYFIRMA research team identified threat actor 'KaruHunters' advertising a database of 35,000 records stolen from Leora Infotech (a Tamil Nadu-based IT consultant) for \$200 on a dark web forum.

5. Emerging Threat Vectors & AI Asymmetry (2026)

The cybersecurity threat landscape is entering a highly accelerated phase driven by artificial intelligence. The collaborative MeitY-SISA Digital Threat Report 2025-26 identifies **AI Asymmetry** as the defining risk of the decade: low-resource attackers are deploying automated AI tools to identify system gaps, write polymorphic malware, and execute attacks at machine speed, far outpacing manual human defenses. Key emerging threats include: (1) *AI Trust Manipulation*, involving the deliberate poisoning of training models; (2) *Social Engineering 2.0*, featuring highly personalized phishing and AI-voice cloned deepfakes impersonating executives to bypass corporate verification; (3) *NFC Relay & Token Hijacking*, targeting digital payment APIs; (4) *Hidden File Vectors*, leveraging SVG files to bypass email security; and (5) *Endpoint Neutralization*, involving kernel-level suspension exploits to freeze EDR monitoring.

Sectoral Threat and Risk Reference Matrix

Sector	Key Confirmed Incidents	Primary Attack Patterns	Triad Impact	Count
BFSI	Angel One, ICICI Bank, NIMF Portal	Cloud Access Compromise, Supply Chain Malware, DDoS	Confidentiality + Availability	3
Healthcare	Niva Bupa, Star Health, Delhi Hospitals	Customer Data Extortion, Server Hacks, Ransomware	Confidentiality + Availability	3
Govt / CNI	Operation Sindoor, Power Grid, BSNL	Coordinated DDoS, Web Defacement, OT Port Scanning	Availability + Integrity	3
Defence / Strategic	SideCopy MSI Campaigns, APT36	DLL Sideloads, Malicious MSI, Spear-Phishing	Confidentiality	2
IT & Services	Tata Technologies, Leora, Sinobi Hack	Managed Services Breach, Ransomware, Dark Web Sale	Confidentiality + Availability	3
Real Estate	Salarpuria Sattva Group Leak	Ransomware-as-a-Service Dark Web Claim	Confidentiality	1
Retail / Mfg	Raymond Ltd Isolation Incident	Unconfirmed Infrastructure Hack, Asset Isolation	Availability	1